

**Keagan Ryder**

## **4-1 Journal: Career Choice and Artifact Update**

**November 24, 2025**

### **Part One**

When I began the Computer Science program, my career goals were broad and somewhat undefined. As I progressed through each course and gained hands-on experience with software engineering, mobile development, and system design, my path became clearer. My career plans have evolved, but they have not undergone a complete change. Instead, they have gradually refined themselves. I still want to work in a software-focused field, but now I understand the type of engineering work that fits my strengths and interests.

My thinking about my career has matured significantly since I started. Early in the program, I simply wanted a job in technology, but now I have a more specific direction built on real project experience. I know that I enjoy building systems end-to-end, solving problems with algorithms, designing efficient data structures, and creating applications that work reliably in real-world environments. Courses like CS 360 and CS 300 helped me recognize how much I enjoy both architectural design and logical problem solving. Additionally, learning about digital privacy throughout the program has made me value secure design principles, which influences how I approach my projects and future career planning.

I have researched potential career paths in software engineering, full stack development, and mobile development. Understanding job expectations, industry tools, and hiring trends has reinforced that my chosen direction is stable and in demand. I have also looked into potential

certifications such as cloud computing or Android development, which could help strengthen my skill set after graduation. I am open to pursuing an advanced degree in software engineering or cybersecurity in the future, depending on how my career progresses after my undergraduate program.

Regarding the capstone course outcomes, I have already achieved several of them through my enhancement work. I have completed initial enhancements for all three required categories and connected each artifact to the appropriate outcome. The remaining work includes completing final enhancements, preparing documentation, and finalizing the ePortfolio structure. I have a clear path forward and am on track to complete all remaining outcomes.

## **Part Two**

### **Status Checkpoints for All Categories**

| <b>Checkpoint</b>        | <b>SDE</b>    | <b>Algorithms</b> | <b>Database</b> |
|--------------------------|---------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Name</b>              | CS 360        | CS 300            | CS 360          |
| <b>Status of IE</b>      | Completed     | In progress       | In progress     |
| <b>Submission Status</b> | Submitted     | Not submitted     | Submitted       |
| <b>Status of FE</b>      | In progress   | Not started       | In progress     |
| <b>Upload to ePort</b>   | In progress   | Not completed     | Not completed   |
| <b>Status of FePort</b>  | Not completed | Not completed     | Not completed   |

### **Optional Artifact Feedback**

I can provide artifact links for review upon request. The main areas where I may need feedback are the clarity of enhancement explanations and ensuring that the depth of technical detail aligns with expectations for CS 499.